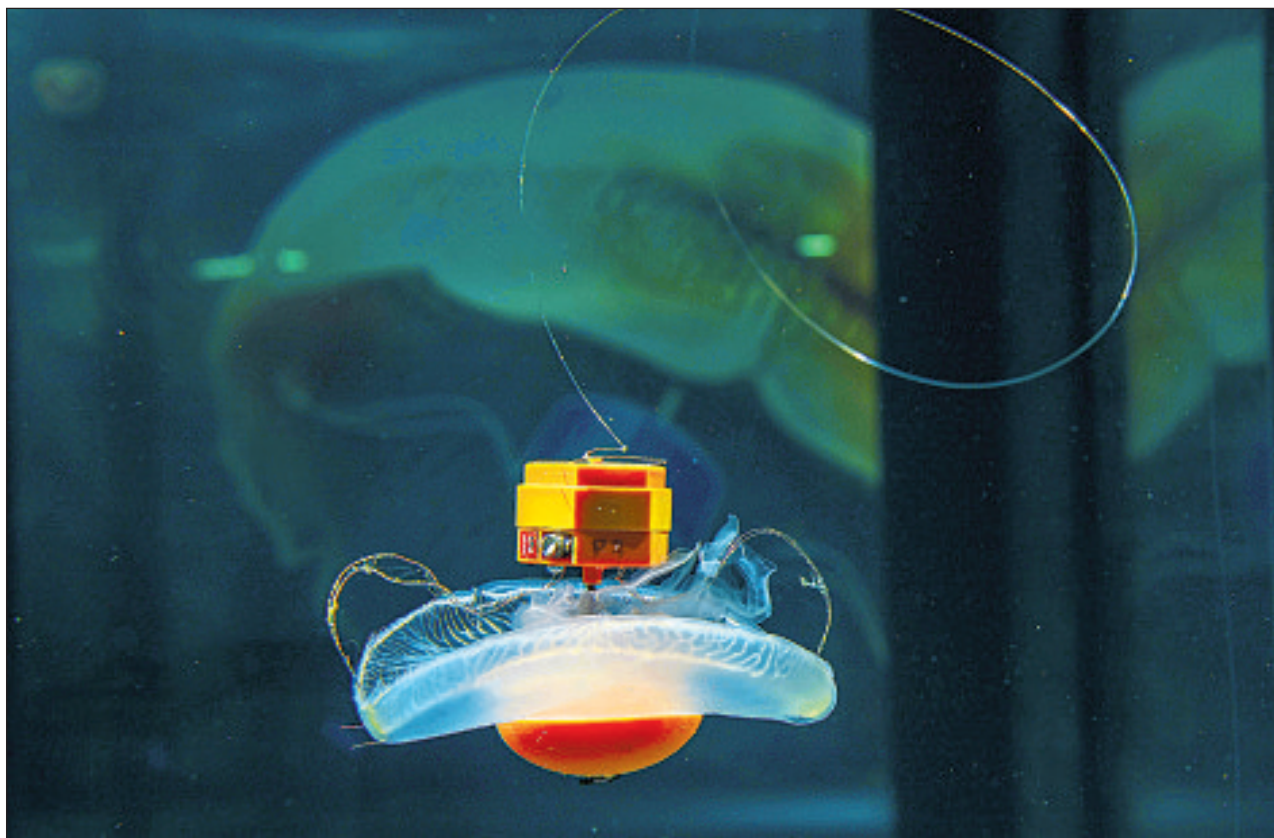




Photographs by ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

A PLAN to use remotely controlled jellyfish would save much of the expense of conventional deep-sea robots.

Deep-sea cyborgs set to explore

Caltech team builds ‘biohybrid’ jellyfish to collect underwater data

By NIAHM ORDNER

For years, science fiction has promised a future filled with robots that can swim, crawl and fly like animals. In one research lab at Caltech, what once felt like distant imagination is becoming reality.

At first glance, they look like any other moon jellyfish — soft-bodied, translucent and ghostlike, as their bell-shaped bodies pulse gently through the water. But look closer, and you’ll spot a tangle of wires, a flash of orange plastic, and a sudden intentional movement.

These are no ordinary jellyfishes. These are cyborgs.



NOA Yoder, a graduate student at the Dabiri Lab at Caltech, is part of a team developing cyborg jellyfish.

At the Dabiri Lab at Caltech, which focuses on the study of fluid dynamics and bio-inspired engineering, researchers are embedding microelectric controllers into jellyfish, creating “biohybrid” devices. The plan: Dispatch these remotely controlled jellyfish robots to collect environmental data at a fraction of the cost of conventional underwater robots — and potentially redefine how we monitor the ocean.

“It fills the niche between high-tech underwater robots and just attaching sensors to animals, which you have little control over where they go,” said Noa Yoder, a [See Jellyfish, A12]

Cal chancellor to face hearing on antisemitism

GOP-led House panel on campus hate has brought down leaders of some elite schools.

By JAWEED KALEEM

UC Berkeley’s top leader on Tuesday will face an influential congressional committee that is aligned with President Trump’s political goal of reshaping higher education by punishing campuses he sees both as bastions of leftist ideologies and as institutions that have tolerated anti-Jewish hate.

Chancellor Rich Lyons’ appearance marks a significant moment for the university, which is under multiple federal investigations over allegations it has violated the civil rights of Jewish students and faculty. The committee Lyons will face has grown from relative obscurity to one of the most rattling in the wake of U.S. campus protests over the Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas-led attack in Israel and Israel’s war in Gaza.

Grillings by the Republican-led group of representatives have led to the dramatic downfalls of the Harvard and University of Pennsylvania presidents and arguably contributed to the resignations of presidents of Columbia, Northwestern

and Rutgers universities. The Trump administration has accused these and other mainly elite campuses of allowing antisemitism to fester amid pro-Palestinian protests since 2023.

Lyons, who became chancellor a year ago, will be the first UC leader to face the House Education & Workforce Committee during the Trump presidency as the White House has moved to dismantle major parts of Harvard’s operation over antisemitism allegations and has pulled billions in research funding from it and other selective universities.

The Trump administration has also detained pro-Palestinian foreign students or canceled their visas, actions that were largely reversed after lawsuits, and foreign students continue to come under increased State Department scrutiny.

The Tuesday hearing will focus on the “role of faculty, funding, and ideology” in antisemitism.

The chancellor’s campus is one of 10 universities under investigation by a task force Trump has directed to combat campus antisemitism. The Education Department notified Lyons via letter in February that Berkeley faced a separate investigation over allegations of antisemitic incidents and posters on campus. The campus is also part of a UC-wide De-

[See Hearing, A6]

Reparation bill aims to skirt race bias ban

By SANDRA McDONALD

SACRAMENTO — With diversity programs under full assault by the Trump administration, California lawmakers are considering a measure that would allow state colleges to consider whether applicants are descendants of African Americans who were enslaved in the United States.

The bill, which would probably face a legal challenge if passed, is part of a package of 15 reparations bills supported by the California Legislative Black Caucus being considered in the current legislative session.

If passed, Assembly Bill 7, introduced by Assembly member Isaac G. Bryan (D-Los Angeles), could potentially skirt around the state’s ban on affirmative action. California voters in 1996 approved a state ballot measure, Proposition 209, that bars colleges from considering race, sex, ethnicity, color

or national origin in admissions under Proposition 209. The U.S. Supreme Court in 2023 also ruled that those programs were unconstitutional.

Bryan, however, says his has nothing to do with race and doesn’t use the terms “Black” or “African American” in its text.

“Descendants of people who are enslaved could identify in a variety of racial ways, and then phenotypically even present in different ways than they racially identify,” he said in an interview with The Times. “But if your ancestors were enslaved in this country, then there’s a direct lineage-based tie to harms that were inflicted during enslavement and in the after lives thereafter.”

The bill, and others in the reparations package, had seen widespread support within the Legislature’s Democratic supermajority and are representative of California’s values, Bryan said.

[See Bill, A5]

Voices GUSTAVO ARELLANO COLUMNIST

Huntington Park’s punishing summer

Immigration sweeps have brought chaos to the Latino hub, with many residents going underground.

Huntington Park High School Principal Carlos Garibaldi was preparing to host a graduation on his campus when frantic colleagues radioed him: Immigration is coming.

A fleet of trucks and vans was speeding up Miles Avenue in front of the school’s main building.

School staffers followed the emergency plan that Garibaldi had discussed

[See Arellano, A5]



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

PATRONS visiting this Huntington Park store have to knock to be allowed in.

Life expectancy for Californians is still down after pandemic

By MARCOS MAGAÑA

During the height of the COVID-19 pandemic, the virus caused life expectancy in California to drop significantly.

It’s now been over two years since officials declared the pandemic-related public health emergency to be over. And yet, life expectancy for Californians has not fully recovered.

Today, however, the virus has been replaced by drug overdoses and cardiovascular disease as the main causes driving down average lifespans.

A new study published in the medical journal JAMA by researchers from UCLA, Northwestern, Princeton and Virginia Commonwealth University finds that the average life expectancy

for Californians in 2024 was nearly a year less than in 2019. The shortfall of 0.86 of a year signals that only about two-thirds of the state’s pandemic-era losses of 2.92 years have been reversed.

Using mortality data from the California Comprehensive Death Files and population estimates from the American Community Survey, the researchers calculated annual life expectancy from 2019 to 2024, breaking the figures down by race, ethnicity, income and cause of death.

Although the COVID-19 virus was the primary factor in life expectancy declines during the pandemic’s peak, accounting for 61.6% of the life expectancy gap, its impact has significantly lessened. In 2024, COVID-19 accounted for only 12.8% of the [See Life expectancy, A7]

New details on pot farm raid

Worker who fell off roof in Camarillo and later died was not being pursued, officials assert. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Texas bracing for more rain

Search for missing flood victims pauses as additional storms will again cause waterways to surge. **NATION, A4**

After a half, L.A. is in first

Yamamoto is strong as Dodgers defeat rival Giants to reach All-Star break atop their division. **SPORTS, D1**

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 80/63. **B5**

Business **A9**
Opinion Voices **A11**

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Numbers dispute Trump’s claim that he targets ‘worst’ immigrants

By MELISSA GOLDIN

President Trump has pledged to deport “the worst of the worst.” He frequently speaks at public appearances about the countless “dangerous criminals” — among them murderers, rapists and child predators — from around the world he says entered the U.S. illegally under the Biden administration. He promises to expel millions of migrants in the largest deportation program in American history to protect law-abiding citizens from the violent threats he says they pose.

But government data around ongoing detentions tell a different story.

There has been an increase of arrests by U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement since Trump began his second term, with reports of raids across the country. Yet the majority of



ANNA MONEYMAKER Associated Press

HOMELAND Security Secretary Kristi Noem, right, in Guatemala City in June after a repatriation flight.

people currently detained by ICE have no criminal convictions. Of those who do, relatively few have been convicted of high-level crimes — a stark contrast to the chilling nightmare Trump describes to support his border security agenda.

“There’s a deep discon-

nect between the rhetoric and the reality,” said Ahilan Arulanantham, co-faculty director of the UCLA Law School’s Center for Immigration Law and Policy. “This administration, and also in the prior Trump administration, they consis-

[See Immigrants, A6]